

2026/27 Hockey Pool Rules, Processes

1. Roster Constraints:
 - a. Teams will have 20 players:
 - i. 12 forwards
 - ii. 6 defensemen
 - iii. 2 goalies
 - b. Teams will remain cap compliant at all times (even in the midst of transactions).
 - i. As of 6/24/2026, this is set to be \$104M
 - ii. This will be confirmed 3 weeks before the draft when the current salaries for players are calculated.
 - c. There will not be a bench for teams.
 - i. Any player on a team counts toward the salary cap and position constraints.
 - ii. If a player cannot play, see the Handling Injuries (4) section below.
2. The Draft:
 - a. We will select the draft order at random.
 - b. The draft will remain a “snake draft”.
 - i. Upon the last user selecting a player, the second round begins with them and works back up the order in reverse.
 - ii. No user may make a selection that, at any given time, would put them over the position maximum or salary cap.
 - iii. All users must have a filled out roster by the end of the draft.
 - c. Player salary caps will be freshly pulled from our source (Spotrac) and sent to the league members 2 weeks before the draft
3. There will be 2 season-long contests.
 - a. Aggregate team totals
 - i. Users earn points by:
 1. Total points (goals/assists) for players rostered on a user’s team throughout the entire season.
 2. Total wins (2 points per), overtime losses (1 point per) and shutouts (1 point per) by goalkeepers rostered on a user’s team throughout the entire season.
 - ii. End of Season Victory:
 1. Regular season (total points)
 2. Tie breaker: team with most goals
 3. Subsequently, the team with the player who has the most individual points
 - b. Head-to-Head competition totals
 - i. Throughout the season each user will have his team face off against each of the other user’s teams 3 times. (ie. if we have 8 teams each team will have 21 head-to-heads)
 - ii. Head-to-head schedule will be published immediately after the draft
 - iii. The victor in a head-to-head will be the team that earn more points that week (Monday 9AM to end of games the following Sunday) The winning

team gets 2 points the loser gets 0 and each team gets 1 point if they end the week with the same aggregate score.

- c. End of Season Victory
 - i. Tie Breaker: team with more straight up wins (not counting 1-point ties)
 - ii. Subsequently, the record between the two teams.
- 4. Handling Injuries:
 - a. A player will be deemed “injured” by the system **once they are placed on LTIR or miss three successive games.**
 - i. Even if the league and tabloids mark a player as being hurt sooner, this will be the metric by which a player is eligible for injury replacement in our league.
 - b. They will be deemed “healthy” and placed back on the roster once they are next dressed for an NHL game. (This accounts for conditioning stints after a player recovers from an injury).
 - c. Upon the system identifying that a player is injured, the manager for that team will be emailed.
 - i. They are then allowed to go into the system and pick a “substitute” from the pool of unclaimed players
 - ii. This “substitute” player must:
 - 1. Have a cap hit which is smaller than or of equal value to that of the injured player;
 - 2. Play the same position as the injured player;
 - 3. Be returned to the pool of unclaimed players once the original player is healthy.
 - iii. The team will not recoup any salary cap for the injured player
 - 1. The substitute player, even if making less money in the eyes of the NHL, will “earn” the amount the original, injured player earned
 - 2. For example, if a 10m player gets hurt and a 3m player is chosen to fill in for them, the team does **not** have 7 more million dollars subtracted from their team cap hit.
 - iv. If a substitute player misses three games in a row, this process repeats for them. With the note that the replacement’s replacement must stay under the original player’s cap hit.
 - 1. For example,
 - 10m gets hurt, 3m steps in and, after a week, gets hurt.
 - An 8m player would be allowed to sub in as they make less than 10m.
 - The first replacement goes back into the pool of unclaimed players.
 - This is done to prevent a case where we have a chain of injuries keeping players from being picked up elsewhere.
 - d. An email will be sent to all league members at the end of each day marking if any injury replacements took place.
 - e. Should you subsequently decide to cut the injured player:

- i. You would remove the replacement player and can use the original player's cap to acquire a new player.
 - ii. Both the original player and their replacement are placed back in the pool of unclaimed players.
- 5. Elective (non injury) Modifications to Roster:
 - a. Each team has the ability to make a maximum of 15 **non-injury** related transactions during the season.
 - b. A transaction consists of
 - i. Dropping a player from your roster **AND**
 - ii. Adding a player back in that position
 - c. A team must be cap/position compliant at the end of each transaction.
 - d. Example:
 - You have 2m in leftover cap space from the draft.
 - You have a forward making 4m and
 - you would like to replace them with a different forward making 10m.
 - You have a goalie making 6m and
 - there is an available goalie making 1m
 - You would first drop the 6m goalie and replace them with the 1m goalie
 - This brings your cap space up to 7m
 - This would be a valid transaction
 - You can then drop your 4m forward (giving you 11m in cap space) and pick up the 10m forward
 - This brings your cap space to 1m
 - This would be a valid transaction
 - e. You are allowed to pick up an injured player, but will be required to follow the injury player protocols above.
 - i. **Note for discussion:**
 - 1. A player begins their three games of injury tracking after they are added to a team
- 6. Trades:
 - a. Each user is allowed 3 trades (total) throughout the season.
 - b. These trades can be performed with any other team that has not yet exhausted their trade quota.
 - c. A trade can consist of as many players as you like so long as the resultant team is cap and positionally compliant.
 - d. To perform a trade, users submit a trade request to the three person ethics committee.
 - i. If the ethics committee approves the trade, the rosters in question are updated.
 - ii. An email is sent out to all users marking that the trade has taken place.
 - iii. Both teams involved are marked as having used one of their 3 allotted trade slots for the season.

Subsequent Notes:

Discussion Points:

- NHL Playoffs is a separate bracket pool outside of this league
- To be discussed, but proposal for the winner to receive a tshirt, hat, or (if they win both) jersey of their favorite player
 - ^ conditional on the final bill being equivalent to what we've paid out in the past.

Reviewers' Notes:

Please write up any of the thoughts or questions you had while reading the above:

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